

COMPETITORS IN DIABETES, WEIGHT-LOSS MARKET

ELI LILLY

KEY PRODUCTS: Mounjaro (tirzepatide), Trulicity (dulaglutide)

POSITIONING: Mounjaro, with its dual-action mechanism, competes directly with Novo's semaglutide in diabetes and weight management.

MARKET OUTLOOK: Eli Lilly's portfolio in this space is expanding rapidly. Mounjaro alone is projected to drive the company's diabetes and obesity drug sales to \$20 billion by 2025.

SOURCES: Company reports, IMS Health

INDIAN PHARMA COMPANIES DEVELOPING ORIGINAL ANTI-OBESITY MOLECULES

1 SUN PHARMACEUTICAL INDUSTRIES

DRUG CANDIDATE:

Utregrlutide (GL0034)

MECHANISM: Long-acting
GLP-1 receptor agonist

INDICATIONS: Obesity and
type 2 diabetes

DEVELOPMENT STAGE:
Preclinical/early clinical trials

EXPECTED LAUNCH:
Within four-five years

2 MANKIND PHARMA

DRUG CANDIDATE:

GPR119 agonist

MECHANISM: Small-molecule
oral therapy targeting the GPR119
receptor

INDICATIONS: Obesity

DEVELOPMENT STAGE: Phase 2
clinical trials in Australia

DETAILS: Mankind is developing what
could be the world's first oral small-
molecule anti-obesity drug, offering
an alternative to injectable treatments

Hospital for Diabetes and Allied Sciences. "With rising rates of obesity and type 2 diabetes, India is a key market where effective medical treatments are urgently needed. Wegovy, a GLP-1 receptor agonist with proven benefits, could play a valuable role, particularly for individuals who have not had success with lifestyle changes alone," says Dr Misra. But its success will hinge on affordability and long-term access. "While I anticipate strong demand among a select group of patients, diet, exercise and lifestyle modifications will continue to be the cornerstone of obesity management for most people. Wegovy is likely to benefit a smaller segment that can afford and adhere to this therapy," he says

Rising obesity in India has created significant demand for effective, non-injection-based treatments. Lilly launched Mounjaro (tirzepatide) in India in March 2025 following approval by the Central Drugs Standard

Control Organisation. Priced between ₹14,000 and ₹17,500 per month, it is available in 2.5 mg and 5 mg doses and treats diabetes as well as obesity. Shrotriya says he doesn't view the new entrants as a threat but a sign that global attention is shifting towards chronic disease management. "We recognise that competition is growing, which is ultimately a positive shift for healthcare, enabling greater awareness and improved solutions."

NOT AN EASY ROAD

Maintaining market share in India is not easy. Cost sensitivity, wide differences in access to healthcare and infrastructure gaps remain hurdles. Novo is responding by building local partnerships and strengthening awareness. "India's obesity market is poised for significant growth, and Novo Nordisk is committed to shaping this evolving landscape through innovation and